

Stress Reasons → KIIT Survey Domains

Mapping

Understanding How Indian Engineering Student Pressures Show Up in the 32-Question Screening

DOMAIN 1: SLEEP (Q1, Q2, Q3, Q4, Q5, Q23–Q26)

What it measures: Circadian disruption, sleep quality, energy patterns, bedtime consistency

Stress Reasons That Trigger Sleep Problems:

Stress Cause	How It Shows in Sleep	Survey Questions
Late-night coding, gaming, cramming	Irregular bedtimes, sleep deprivation, poor quality	Q4 (bedtime variable), Q23 (poor quality), Q24 (fragmented)
Exam pressure & deadlines	Early morning waking (4-5 AM), can't fall back asleep	Q25 (early waking 4-5 AM)—CARDINAL depression marker
Rumination about exams/placements	Evening mind activity, can't quiet mind before sleep	Q9 (evening rumination—with context clause)
Caffeine/energy drink use (coping mechanism)	Insomnia, fragmented sleep, inconsistent rhythm	Q23, Q24, Q26
Stress from family pressure	Circadian disruption, anxiety-induced insomnia	Q1 (weekend compensation), Q2 (afternoon fatigue)
Hostel noise, roommate conflict	Sleep fragmentation, difficulty staying asleep	Q24 (fragmented), Q23 (poor quality)

Key Clinical Pearl:

- **Q25=D (4-5 AM waking)** is the highest-specificity depression marker. If student wakes 4-5 AM during exam season = understandable stress response. But **persistent early waking outside exam season** = depression/anxiety signal.

DOMAIN 2: AVOIDANCE (Q6, Q7a, Q19, Q20, Q21, Q22)

What it measures: Procrastination, task initiation, coping style, self-care, exercise, substance use

Stress Reasons That Trigger Avoidance:

Stress Cause	How It Shows in Avoidance	Survey Questions
Academic pressure & perfectionism	Procrastination ("deadline pressure gets me going")	Q6 (D option—delay until crisis)

Stress Cause	How It Shows in Avoidance	Survey Questions
Fear of failure/judgment	Difficulty starting tasks, avoidant coping	Q6 (C option—feel stuck starting)
CGPA anxiety (grades determine worth)	Task avoidance, crisis mode coping	Q6 + Q27 together = perfectionism-avoidance loop
Parental pressure, shame	Rumination + avoidance combo; withdraw when stressed	Q19 (D—withdraw alone, ruminate)
Sleep deprivation + exhaustion	No exercise, self-care neglect	Q21 (never exercise), Q22 (neglect hygiene)
Financial stress	Working part-time = no time for exercise/meals	Q21 (no activity), Q22 (self-care lapse)
Hostel chaos, lack of motivation	Everything feels pointless; avoidance	Q21, Q22 together = behavioral deactivation
Using substances to cope (alcohol, caffeine, stimulants)	Self-medication pattern; coping mechanism	Q20 (frequent drinking/substance use to manage stress)

Key Clinical Pearl:

- **Q6=D + Q19=D + Q21=D + Q22=D = Behavioral Deactivation Triad** (depression severity is high)
- **Q6=D + Q27=D + Q28=D = Perfectionism-Avoidance Loop** (burnout + anxiety)

DOMAIN 3: RUMINATION (Q8, Q9, Q10, Q7b, Q14, Q16, Q18, Q28)

What it measures: Worry loops, catastrophizing, post-failure shame, cognitive stuckness, future pessimism

Stress Reasons That Trigger Rumination:

Stress Cause	How It Shows in Rumination	Survey Questions
Parental pressure, high expectations	Shame-based rumination after any setback	Q8 (D—"I'm not good at this; I feel ashamed") + Q28 (D—deep shame over low grades)
Comparison with peers	Constant rumination about "Sharma ji ka beta"; upward comparison	Q14 (D—constant comparison/self-judgment)
Exam/placement anxiety	Catastrophizing: "What if I fail? What if no package?"	Q16 (D—cycling through bad outcomes), Q10 (D—hopelessness)
Fear of falling behind	Rumination about being "left behind" by peers	Q14 + Q16 together = comparison + catastrophizing
Guilt about parents' sacrifice	Rumination about family expectations; shame about failure	Q8 + Q28 = shame triad
Evening stress (hostel context)	Mind cycles through worries at night (CONTEXT: non-exam weeks)	Q9 (D—worry cycles in evening)
Breakups or social conflicts	Rumination about rejection, what went wrong	Q8 (replaying mistakes), Q28 (shame)
Decision paralysis (major life choices)	Overthinking, second-guessing decisions	Q7b (D—constant reconsideration), Q16 (catastrophizing outcomes)
Perfectionism + identity conflict	Rumination about "Am I good enough?" + "Who am I?"	Q14 + Q27 = comparison + worth-linkage

Key Clinical Pearl:

- **Q8=D + Q28=D + Q16=D = Shame + Catastrophizing Triad** (high anxiety + depression risk)
- **Evening rumination Q9 at KIIT:** Students ruminate during exam season (normative), but baseline rumination outside exams = mood disorder signal

DOMAIN 4: PERFECTIONISM (Q27, Q28, Q29)

What it measures: Worth-achievement linkage, failure shame response, impostor syndrome

Stress Reasons That Trigger Perfectionism:

Stress Cause	How It Shows in Perfectionism	Survey Questions
Family conditional support	"My worth = my grades"; shame-driven perfectionism	Q27 (D—grades determine worth)
CGPA pressure for placements	Impossible standards, fear of B grades	Q27 + Q28 together = worth-linkage + shame
Comparison culture	"I must be better than others"	Q27 + Q14 = perfectionism + comparison
Parental investment, guilt	Perfectionism as repayment for parents' sacrifice	Q27 (D—achieving = survival)
High-achievement environment at KIIT	Perfectionistic expectations (normative for institute)	Q27=D common, but Q27=D + Q8=D + Q28=D = pathological
Impostor feelings	Succeeding but not believing it, constant self-doubt	Q29 (D—fraud syndrome)
Low self-esteem with high standards	Striving hard but never feeling "good enough"	Q29 + Q14 + Q27 = perfectionism + doubt + comparison

Key Clinical Pearl:

- **High Q27 at KIIT is COMMON/NORMATIVE** (competitive culture), BUT:
 - **Q27=D + Q8=D (shame) + Q28=D = Maladaptive Perfectionism** (pathological)
 - **Q27=A/B + High performance = Healthy striving** (no intervention needed)

DOMAIN 5: ISOLATION (Q11, Q12, Q13)

What it measures: Social belonging, social initiation, perceived support

Stress Reasons That Trigger Isolation:

Stress Cause	How It Shows in Isolation	Survey Questions
Homesickness, away from family	Difficulty fitting in hostel groups; outsider feelings	Q11 (C/D—uncertain/like outsider)
Hostel conflicts, roommate issues	Withdrawal from social groups, isolation	Q12 (D—don't initiate plans)
Bullying, feeling excluded	Avoidance of social situations, loneliness	Q11 + Q12 together = isolation triad beginning

Stress Cause	How It Shows in Isolation	Survey Questions
Friendship conflicts	Breakup fallout, choosing sides, feeling alone	Q11 + Q12 + Q13 = full isolation triad
Lack of emotional family support	Can't confide in parents about struggles; feel alone	Q13 (D—not confident family would understand/support)
Fear of judgment (failure, breakup, etc.)	Hide struggles, withdraw from friends	Q13 (C/D—not confident of non-judgment support)
Feeling "not good enough" (perfectionism + shame)	Shame-driven withdrawal	Q12 + Q8 = shame-driven isolation
Academic stress isolates	Everyone busy cramming; no time for relationships	Q12 (low social initiation)
Social media comparison (seeing others' friend groups)	Feeling left out of relationships	Q14 + Q12 = comparison + isolation

Key Clinical Pearl:

- **Isolation Triad = Q11=D + Q12=D + Q13=D** (very high loneliness/depression risk)
- **Isolation Triad + Q10=D (hopeless) = SUICIDE RISK ALERT** (mandatory clinician review)
- **Q11=D + Q11-Follow-up=A = Introversion** (healthy; not pathology)
- **Q11=D + Q11-Follow-up=D = Social Anxiety/Depression** (clinical concern)

DOMAIN 6: ANHEDONIA (Loss of Pleasure) (Q30, Q31, Q32)

What it measures: Loss of pleasure in activities, emotional numbing, life dissatisfaction

Stress Reasons That Trigger Anhedonia:

Stress Cause	How It Shows in Anhedonia	Survey Questions
Chronic academic stress	Everything feels pointless; hobbies feel flat	Q30 (D—nothing brings joy)
Burnout from overwork	Used to enjoy gaming/Minecraft, now feels empty	Q30 (C/D—less pleasure than before)
Sleep deprivation	Fatigue makes joy/pleasure impossible	Q30 + Q2 = tiredness + anhedonia
Depression cascade (from long-term stress)	Loss of all pleasure; numbness	Q30=D + Q31=D = severe depression signal
Hopelessness about future	Can't enjoy present because future looks bleak	Q32 (D—life dissatisfied)
Shame from failure	Guilt makes it hard to enjoy anything	Q28=D + Q30=D = shame-driven anhedonia
Isolation + rejection	Breakup, friendship loss, exclusion kills joy	Q30 + Q13 = anhedonia + isolation
Emotional numbing (dissociation from stress)	Feeling nothing—not sad, not happy, just flat	Q31 (D—emotionally numb)

Key Clinical Pearl:

- **Q30=D + Q31=D + Q32=D = Severe Depression** (high suicide risk; urgent referral needed)
- **Q30=C (some pleasure loss) + Q10=A (hopeful) = Not necessarily clinical** (could be temporary burnout)

- **Q30=D + Q25=D + Q24=D = Depression Symptom Cluster** (sleep + anhedonia = high confidence depression)

DOMAIN 7: CONTROL & AUTONOMY (Q15, Q17, Q18)

What it measures: Perceived control, identity conflict, cognitive flexibility, locus of control

Stress Reasons That Trigger Low Control Perception:

Stress Cause	How It Shows in Control	Survey Questions
Parental control over major decisions	Career chosen by parents; no say in future	Q15 (C/D—low personal control)
Family expectations override personal values	Want to do arts, but parents pushed engineering	Q17 (C/D—conflict between expectations vs. self)
CGPA determines everything	"My grades determine my life, my worth"	Q15 + Q27 together = low control + worth-linkage
Rigid family values vs. personal identity	Cannot be authentic; must fit family mold	Q17 (D—severe conflict)
Placement system's unpredictability	Can study hard but "no guarantee" = helplessness	Q15 (D—very low control, determined by circumstances)
Financial dependence on parents	Can't make autonomous choices; controlled by money	Q15 (C/D—lack autonomy)
Gender expectations (especially for women)	Pressure to be "traditional"; can't be self	Q17 (D—identity conflict from external pressure)
Can't change college/hostel situation	Stuck in bad hostel/batch but can't transfer	Q15 + Q17 = low control + identity conflict
Cognitive rigidity from stress	"I always fail, so nothing will change"	Q18 (D—can't reconsider views even with evidence)

Key Clinical Pearl:

- **Q15=D + Q10=D = Helplessness + Hopelessness Triad** (depression VERY HIGH confidence)
- **Q17=D (conflict) alone** = Likely cultural/developmental, not pathological
- **Q17=D + Q8=D (shame) + Q31=D (numbness) = Clinical concern** (identity disturbance from depression/trauma)
- **At KIIT:** Many students score Q15=C/D due to family involvement in major decisions (CULTURAL NORM, not necessarily depression)

INTEGRATED STRESS → SYMPTOM PATHWAYS

Pathway 1: Academic Pressure → Depression

Heavy Workload (Q6 procrastination)
→ Sleep Deprivation (Q23-26, Q1-5)
→ Fatigue & Anhedonia (Q30, Q2)
→ Avoidance (Q19-Q22)

- Behavioral Deactivation (Q21, Q22)
- Depression (High Rumination + Anhedonia + Low Control)

Red Flag Cluster: Q6=D + Q23=D + Q30=D + Q25=D

Pathway 2: Parental Pressure → Anxiety + Perfectionism

- Family Conditional Support (Q15 low control, Q17 conflict)
- Worth-Achievement Linkage (Q27=D)
- Perfectionism + Shame (Q28=D, Q8=D)
- Catastrophizing (Q16=D)
- Evening Rumination (Q9=D)
- Anxiety Disorder (High Perfectionism + Rumination + Sleep Problems)

Red Flag Cluster: Q27=D + Q28=D + Q16=D + Q9=D

Pathway 3: Hostel Loneliness → Depression + Suicidal Risk

- Homesickness + Hostel Conflicts (Q11=D, Q12=D)
- Isolation & Loneliness (Q13=D, Q12=D)
- No Emotional Support (Q13=D—can't confide)
- Shame from Struggles (Q8=D, Q28=D)
- Hopelessness (Q10=D)
- Anhedonia + Emotional Blunting (Q30=D, Q31=D)
- Depression + Suicidal Ideation (URGENT)

Red Flag Cluster: Q11=D + Q12=D + Q13=D + Q10=D + Q31=D = **SUICIDE RISK**

Pathway 4: Breakup/Social Rejection → Depression

- Friendship Conflict or Breakup (triggering event)
- Shame + Rumination (Q8=D, Q28=D about the loss)
- Withdrawal (Q12=D, Q19=D)
- Loss of Joy (Q30=D—things used to enjoy now feel empty)
- Hopelessness (Q10=D—future looks empty)
- Depression (Shame + Isolation + Anhedonia)

Red Flag Cluster: Q8=D + Q30=D + Q12=D + Q10=D

Pathway 5: Impostor Syndrome + Perfectionism → Burnout

- High Achievement (getting good grades, placements)
- Impostor Feelings (Q29=D—"I'm a fraud")
- Worth-Linkage (Q27=D—only valid when succeeding)

- Comparison Rumination (Q14=D—must stay ahead)
- Perfectionism (Q27 + Q29 high)
- Chronic Stress + Sleep Loss (Q23-26 problems)
- Burnout (Perfectionism + Rumination + Sleep Problems)

Red Flag Cluster: Q29=D + Q27=D + Q14=D + Q23=D + Q9=D

QUICK REFERENCE: WHICH SURVEY ITEMS MATCH WHICH STRESSOR?

KIIT Stressor	Primary Domain	Key Questions	Secondary Domains
Exam/Deadline Pressure	Sleep, Avoidance, Rumination	Q6, Q23-26, Q9	Perfectionism (Q27-28)
Parental Expectations	Control, Perfectionism, Isolation	Q15, Q17, Q27	Rumination (Q8, Q28)
CGPA/Placement Anxiety	Perfectionism, Rumination, Avoidance	Q27, Q16, Q6	Sleep (Q25), Control (Q15)
Hostel Loneliness	Isolation, Anhedonia	Q11, Q12, Q13, Q30	Sleep, Control
Breakup/Social Conflict	Isolation, Rumination, Anhedonia	Q8, Q12, Q30	Sleep, Avoidance
Sleep Deprivation	Sleep, Avoidance, Anhedonia	Q23-26, Q21, Q30	Control, Avoidance
Financial Stress	Avoidance, Anhedonia, Control	Q21, Q22, Q15	Sleep, Isolation
Perfectionism/Impostor	Perfectionism, Rumination, Isolation	Q27, Q29, Q8, Q14	Sleep, Anhedonia
Burnout	Perfectionism, Sleep, Avoidance	Q27, Q23-26, Q21-22	Anhedonia (Q30), Rumination

CLINICAL INTERPRETATION TIPS FOR KIIT STUDENTS

✓ HIGH-RISK PATTERNS (Urgent Intervention)

1. Isolation Triad + Hopelessness: Q11=D + Q12=D + Q13=D + Q10=D → **Suicide Risk** (same-day assessment)
2. Sleep Disruption + Anhedonia: Q25=D + Q24=D + Q30=D → **Depression** (within 1 week)
3. Shame Triad + Numbness: Q8=D + Q28=D + Q31=D → **Severe Depression** (urgent)
4. Perfectionism + Shame + Catastrophizing: Q27=D + Q28=D + Q16=D → **High Anxiety + Burnout** (within 2-3 weeks)

⚠ MODERATE-RISK PATTERNS (Counseling Recommended)

5. Avoidance Loop: Q6=D + Q19=D + Q21=D + Q22=D → **Depression-like Behavioral Deactivation** (within 2-3 weeks)
6. Rumination + Sleep Problems: Q9=D + Q23=D + Q16=D → **Anxiety with Sleep Issues** (within 2-3 weeks)

7. **Identity Conflict + Shame:** Q17=D + Q8=D + Q27=D → **Parental Pressure Distress** (within 4 weeks)

NORMAL/DEVELOPMENTAL (Monitor, Don't Pathologize)

8. **Exam-Week Sleep Disruption:** Q25=D (but only during exam season) + Q23=D (temporary) → **Stress response** (monitor after exams)

9. **High Perfectionism (Normative at KIIT):** Q27=C/D + Q29=C (but Q28=A/B, Q8=A/B) → **Healthy striving** (protective if not shame-driven)

10. **Academic Comparison (Normative):** Q14=C (but Q16=A/B, Q10=A/B) → **Normal peer awareness** (not catastrophizing)

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For: KIIT Mental Health Screening System Implementation

Purpose: Help clinicians understand how real student stressors map to survey responses